

Design Principles

1. **Visibility**

If I press this button, what will happen? If I wanted to unlock the door, which control should I use?

A system with good visibility allows the user to easily translate goals into actions.

2. **Feedback**

What is it should do now?

Once the user has pressed a button, the system should react in a manner that clearly communicates what has just been accomplished. If nothing has happened, this fact should also be obvious.

3. **Constraints**

Why can't I do that?

It limits your interaction to minimize potential action slips and mistakes.

4. **Mapping**

Where am I and where can I go?

It provides your current state and possible next actions while interacting with a system.

5. **Consistency**

I think I have seen this before.

It provides familiarity and consistency throughout your interaction with the system.

6. **Affordance**

The system should provide "strong clues to the operation of things".

A button affords pushing, a lever affords pulling, etc.

The user should know how to operate a control just by looking at it.